

FLOMASTER

USER GUIDE

V2.3 - WINDOWS 10/11

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FLOMASTER is a launcher for 3D graphics applications: one button starts Blender, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Unreal Engine or Substance Painter with a predefined OCIO color config. The launcher finds installed applications automatically, keeps launch presets, opens project files and logs every launch. One color config - across all applications, with no manual environment setup.

github.com/abyrvalg379/FLOMASTER

CONTENTS

1. About FLOMASTER.....	3
2. Installation.....	3
3. Quick start.....	3
4. Presets and auto-scan.....	3
5. Project files.....	4
6. How OCIO support works.....	4
7. Themes.....	4
8. Settings.....	5
9. Tray and log.....	5
10. Files and folders.....	5
11. Workflows.....	5
12. Troubleshooting.....	6

1. ABOUT FLOMASTER

Key features:

- auto-scan of installed applications: Blender, K-Cycles, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Unreal Engine, Substance Painter;
- launch presets: your own name, exe and launch arguments;
- project file opening (.blend, .spp, .ma, .mb, .hip, .hipl, .hipnc, .nk) with OCIO applied;
- 7 color themes styled after the applications they launch;
- drag and drop: an exe becomes a preset, a project file opens in the chosen application;
- system tray with quick launch under the default config;
- launch log: timestamp, user, application, config, exit code;
- bundled ACES 1.2 OCIO config with lowercase acescg / raw aliases.

2. INSTALLATION

- Download the latest release: github.com/abyrvalg379/FLOMASTER → Releases → Latest.
- Extract the archive to a folder of your choice (e.g. C:\Program Files\FLOMASTER).
- Run FLOMASTER.exe. The build is self-contained: .NET 8 is bundled, nothing else to install.
- The window opens in the top-right corner of the screen. User data (settings and the log) is created in %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\.
- Updating: close the launcher (including the tray), replace the files, start it again. Settings and the log live apart from the program and survive updates.

3. QUICK START

- Start FLOMASTER - the auto-scan finds installed applications and their cards appear in the window.
- Click Launch on a card - the application starts with the launcher OCIO config.
- Check the color spaces in the application (in Blender - the Color Management tab in scene properties).
- Drag a project file (.blend, .ma, .hip...) onto a card - it opens in that application under the same config.
- Make it yours: theme and scan paths are in Settings, the default tray config is there too.

4. PRESETS AND AUTO-SCAN

4.1 Auto-scan

On start the launcher looks for installed applications in standard locations. Something installed in a non-standard folder (portable builds, custom versions)? Add the folder in Settings → Scan paths and the card appears on the next scan.

4.2 Custom presets

A preset is a pair of "name + path to exe". Two ways to create one:

- drag the application exe right into the launcher window - you will be asked for a name;
- create a preset manually and point it to the exe.

Each preset carries its own launch arguments (the Quick Commands menu on the card) - that is how you keep several versions of one application or special launch keys.

5. PROJECT FILES

Drag a project file onto an application card - it opens there with the OCIO config applied.

Supported: .blend, .spp, .ma, .mb, .hip, .hipl, .hipnc, .nk. Recently opened files are available in the Recent list.

The Windows context menu entry "Open in FLOMASTER" (right-click on a project file) works the same way.

6. HOW OCIO SUPPORT WORKS

Most applications read the config path from the OCIO environment variable - the launcher sets it on launch.

Unreal Engine ignores the variable: it receives the path as a `-ocio="path"` argument - the launcher does that for you.

APPLICATION	METHOD
Blender, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Substance Painter	OCIO environment variable
Unreal Engine	-ocio= argument

The bundled ACES 1.2 config (the ocio/ folder next to the exe) defines lowercase aliases `acescg` and `raw`: interchange ACES names identical across applications and configs. Scripts and presets that set a colorspace by the `acescg` or `raw` string survive config changes - long names like "ACES - ACEScg" are unique to one config. The transforms behind an alias and its long name are identical.

Default roles in the bundled config are tuned for a typical texture cycle: 8-bit images open as raw, float images (EXR) - as `acescg`.

7. THEMES

Seven color schemes - one per application in the pipeline. Switch the theme in Settings; the entire interface follows: buttons, checkboxes, the scrollbar, dropdown menus and the Launch button hover state.

THEME	ACCENT	BASE
Blender	orange	dark graphite
Maya	cyan	blue-gray
Houdini	red-orange	dark (sampled from the real UI)
Nuke	light gray	graphite, monochrome
DaVinci	pink-red	purple-navy
Unreal	blue	cool graphite
Substance	green	black

8. SETTINGS

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Theme	interface color theme
Start with Windows	auto-start minimized to tray with Windows
Always on top	window above all others
Smooth animation	enable/disable panel animation
Default OCIO	default config for tray launches
Scan paths	extra folders for the auto-scan
Shortcuts	Start Menu and desktop shortcuts

9. TRAY AND LOG

Closing the window minimizes the launcher to the system tray - it keeps running. The tray menu offers quick launch of applications under the default config.

The Log button opens the log window beside the launcher (same height, to the left or right - wherever it fits). Every launch is logged: timestamp, user, application, OCIO config, exit code. A "Set OCIO=..." line marks that the config was actually passed. The log file lives at %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\flomaster.log.

10. FILES AND FOLDERS

PATH	CONTENTS
installation folder	FLOMASTER.exe, flomaster.ico, ocio/ (ACES 1.2 config + luts/), LICENSE.txt
%APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\	launcher_config.json (settings), flomaster.log (log)

The program and user data are deliberately separated: reinstalling and updating never touch settings, presets or the log.

11. WORKFLOWS

One color from the start of the day

Launcher window → Launch on the application you need. Everything you start that day runs on the same config - files travel between applications without color surprises.

Textures: what opens and where

Float images (EXR) open as acescg - the color cycle is correct right away. 8-bit images open as raw: the right default for data maps (normals, masks, roughness) with no manual clicks. Assign a colorspace manually to a color 8-bit map if it opened as raw.

Open a scene in another application

Drag the scene file onto the application card - or use Recent to reopen the last file without hunting for it in the file manager.

Several versions of one application

Create one preset per version (drag the exe + name) and start the one you need with a click; the version arguments live in the preset Quick Commands.

12. TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
Application missing after installation	non-standard install folder	add the folder in Settings → Scan paths or create a preset by dragging the exe
Unreal started with the wrong color	Unreal does not read the OCIO variable	keep the -ocio= argument in the preset arguments - that is how the launcher passes the config
Error «enum "Non-Color" not found» on import	the bundled config has no colorspace named Non-Color (the raw alias exists)	import outside this OCIO config, or add a colorspace/alias with that name to the config
A color 8-bit map opened as raw	the default_byte role in the config is raw (the default for data maps)	assign a colorspace manually to that map: sRGB space for 8-bit color, acescg for float
Log window is nowhere to be seen	it opens beside the launcher, at the same height	look to the left/right of the launcher window
Settings and log "disappeared" after reinstall	they do not live in the program folder	look in %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\ - updates never touch them
Cannot replace the exe when updating	the launcher is running (including the tray) and the file is locked	close FLOMASTER completely, then replace the files